

LAS 6292 DATA MANAGEMENT PLAN

Assignment overview

The Data Management Plan (DMP) is a critical document describing the data to be collected for a research project, how it will be stored and managed, and the investigator with primary responsibility for its management. Many funding agencies, including NSF and NIH, now require a DMP with all grant applications. *Your assignment is to prepare a Data Management Plan (DMP) for your thesis research.* I **strongly** recommend that you prepare your DMP using the template from the online **DMP Tool** (<https://dmptool.org>) best suited to your research.

Due Date: 27 March 2026

Point Value: 125 points.

Submission: Please submit the assignment via Canvas; you may submit either (a) a link granting access to your plan on the DMP Planner website *or* (b) a copy of the file in either .pdf or .txt format *or* (c) a link to the Github archive where I can review the file.

DMP Peer review: You will be asked to conduct a peer review of a colleague's draft DMP. This peer review is worth 25 pts and is due 3 April 2026. *After receiving the Peer Review and Instructor Feedback you can edit your DMP and submit it for a regrade.*

Grading

Your submission will be evaluated using the point values, minimum standards, and rubric below. The individual components will be evaluated as “Meets required standards”, “Moderate revisions required to meet the minimum standards”, “Major revisions required to meet the minimum standards”, or as “Incomplete / Unacceptable”. In addition, I have noted a series of additional (optional) steps that can be taken to earn a designation of “Exceptional Work” on each section that can result in a bonus of up to 10%. ***The point values for each grade category are as follows:***

- Meets standards = 125-112 points
- Moderate revisions = 111-100 points
- Major revisions = 99-88 points
- Incomplete / Unacceptable = 87-62 points
- Potential Bonus = 12 points

Rubric

Not all DMPs include the same information, and you should refer to the course materials to decide what to include and for examples from different disciplines. That said, ***to receive a score of ‘Meets Minimum Standards’ - regardless of discipline - the DMP must information from the following broad categories:***

Category 1: Administrative Information

- Project title
- Researcher name and contact information
- Details of any relevant institutional policies (e.g., IRB, IP, IAUCUC)
- Names of funders that supported the data collection
- Who is using the data
- Who is responsible for managing the data?
- Who will ensure that the data management plan is carried out?

Category 2: Information on Data Collection

- The purpose of research for which the data are being collected.
- The kind of samples and data that were collected
- How collected and how often
- Format of raw data (paper, digital, image, audio)
- How much data: number of samples, number and size of files, total size of digital archive.
- Reproducibility of collection or analysis and if collection used standard methods
- Metadata files, code books, or other documentation needed by other researchers to use and interpret data, including how archived

Category 3: Information on data formats and standards, storage, and backup

- Data formats and if (a) standard for the field and (b) open or proprietary.
- Repository in which data will be archived
- Short- and long-term data storage and preservation (physical, digital) procedures
- Plans for regular data backup
- Plans to ensure security of private/restricted data
- Financial costs related to data archiving or storage (if appropriate)
- Plans to ensure long-term data use (i.e., storage media, file formats, etc.)
- Any tools or software are required to read or view the data

Category 4: Information on data sharing and access policies

- How personal or sensitive information have been removed to ensure privacy protection.
- Who holds intellectual property rights for the data and other information created by the project and if there any patent- or technology-licensing-related restrictions on data sharing.
- Whether re-use, redistribution, or the creation of new tools, services, data sets, or products will be permitted and if commercial use is allowed.
- Any embargoes on the data
- The attribution of credit to individuals and institutions, including funders.
- The length of time the data will be retained (if not permanently archived)

Evaluation of ‘Exceptional’

An evaluation of “Exceptional” requires the following:

- The DMP must meet include all information required for “Meets Standards”
- A DMP file generated with Rmarkdown or Quarto; with the file saved to Github or similar to allow for version control